The Boston Globe

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MONDAY, OCTOBER 12, 2026

In Mass., Latino population is struggling

Holds lowest levels of wealth but will soon make up majority of new workers

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Fluent in Spanish and armed with a master's degree in economics, Katheryn Gravenhorst is well equipped to launch a career in data analysis or consulting.

But months after graduating, Gravenhorst, 24, is still working as a shift manager at a Dunkin' in Salem.

Gravenhorst was the first person in her family to graduate from college. She left Colombia at 16 to live with her aunt in Lynn and had to work multiple jobs throughout her five years at the University of Massachusetts Boston, mainly at Dunkin', which left her with little time to make connections or hold out for internships that provided experience in her field.

Today, in the worst labor market for recent college graduates since COVID, her spreadsheet of job applications keeps growing.

$1,200
Median net wealth for Latino families in Massachusetts

"I was trying to build my resume, but at the same time I was trying to survive," she said. "I feel like I would have better job prospects if I had more time to network."

Gravenhorst is facing more barriers than a lousy job market. She's also trying to launch her career in a state where Latinos in many ways fare more poorly than anywhere else in the country. They have the

LATINOS, Page A7



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

The notch presented hiker Julius Pearson with precarious patches of boulders to hop over and climb through.

BETWEEN LOTS OF ROCKS AND A BRUTALLY HARD PLACE

Legendary Appalachian Trail takes a fiendish twist here: Mahoosuc Notch



By Billy Baker and Jessica Rinaldi
GLOBE STAFF

MAHOOSUC NOTCH, MAINE

It's called "the toughest mile on the Appalachian Trail," though that's being a bit loose with the term "trail."

"This is choose-your-own-adventure," a hiker named Julius Pearson said on a recent day while slowly sliding and squeezing through Mahoosuc Notch, a narrow, mile-long ravine in a remote section of Maine that is mostly filled with boulders the size of cars. The ones that aren't are the size of houses.

The trail dates to 1916, when hikers first noticed the ravine from the top of Mount Washington and had the questionable idea to carve a trail through it. Or at least slap some paint on the occasional rock and pretend it's a trail. Since then, Mahoosuc Notch has thrilled some, freaked out others (it is not for the claustrophobic), and become a major — and majorly feared — benchmark for the thousands like Pearson who set out each year to "thru-hike" the

MAHOOSUC NOTCH, Page A6

Brigham nurses postpone strike

Will vote on potential contract; hospital extends its 'best and final offer'

By Marin Wolf and Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

An eight-month labor battle that brought one of Boston's most prominent hospitals to the brink of a major nursing strike has reached a possible turning point, with nearly 4,000 nurses postponing a planned walkout to consider a final contract offer, according to union officials.

The decision came after the 27th bargaining session Saturday between the unionized nurses at Brigham and Women's Hospital and hospital leadership, but the threat of a strike still looms as key disagreements over wages remain unresolved.

Brigham nurses will have the opportunity to vote on the proposal, although a date has not been scheduled, said Massachusetts Nurses Association spokesperson Joe Markman. It will likely take place in about two weeks, he said.

Pending the outcome of the vote, the union will decide whether to proceed with the indefinite strike, originally slated to start Wednesday.

The postponement temporarily averts a walkout that could have disrupted patient care and hospital operations. Union members had prepared to go without pay and lose Brigham's contributions toward their health insurance premiums.

NURSES, Page A7

Eversource workers gave to Healey

Donations came in before gas pipeline review request

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

In the weeks before Governor Maura Healey urged an expedited review of a natural gas pipeline expansion project, Eversource executives and lobbyists donated thousands of dollars to her campaign, campaign finance records show.

Facing steep pressure to slash energy prices, Healey says she has embraced an "all of the above" approach to energy, including backing the project, which would expand the capacity of a gas pipeline system Eversource uses in Southeastern Massachusetts and Rhode Island. But some climate advocates said they were troubled by the timing of the contributions.

In September, Eversource employees donated more than $9,000 to Healey and Lieutenant Governor Kim Driscoll, including $1,000 to each from chief executive Joseph Nolan Jr., the annual maxi-

EVERSOURCE, Page A10



Breaking out

Monday: Clouds then sun.
High 66-71. Low 52-57.
Tuesday: Cloudy, showers.
High 62-67. Low 58-63.
Sunrise: 6:53 Sunset: 6:07

Obituaries, **B6**
Comics and Weather, **D4-5**

The New Hampshire Supreme Court dismissed the latest petition from the only person on death row in New England, ensuring he will stay there, for now. **B1.**

VOL. 310, NO. 104
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Suggested retail price
$4.00

0 947725 41113

R.I. Italian American community split as gender war simmers

Women's Auxiliary members of society want equal standing

By Amanda Milkovits and Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF

CRANSTON, R.I. — When dozens of Italian American women walked into the lobby of the Santa Maria di Prata Society recently, passing the chapel of the Blessed Mother and Child, for their traditional Tuesday night card games and bocce, they found the door to the lounge locked.

What followed next underscored the unusual gender war over the modern rules (or lack thereof) in an organization meant to celebrate the history and culture of Italian Americans, one that has gone far beyond acrimony to involve the police, a no-trespass order, and the threat of a lawsuit.

The male members of the society had already occupied the lounge, and its president, Anthony Mastantuono, was insisting the women prove their membership in the Women's Auxiliary before being allowed inside.

"I've been a member for 17 years. I've never had to show my card, never, ever," one of the women responded as she and the others waved their auxiliary membership cards at Mastantuono and pushed past him into the lounge.

SOCIETY, Page A10

PATRIOTS STOMP RAIDERS, 45-17



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

New England Patriots tight end Hunter Henry celebrated after his touchdown reception against the Las Vegas Raiders at Gillette Stadium on Sunday. Quarterback Drake Maye finished the day with five total touchdowns and no turnovers. **C1.**